

Technology in Society — Journal Requirements

Source: Elsevier ScienceDirect, Guide for Authors, manuscripts.com submission guide **Last verified:** June 4, 2026 **ISSN:** 0160-791X

Aims and Scope

Technology in Society is an international journal devoted to the global discourse at the intersection of technological change and social, economic, business, and philosophical transformation. It publishes scholarship that enables decision-makers to engage thoughtfully with technologies.

Approaches accepted: - Scholarly/theoretical (history and philosophy of S&T, technology forecasting, economic growth, policy, ethics) - Applied (business innovation, technology management, legal, engineering) - Development perspectives

Recent research directions: - AI ethics and AI governance - Algorithmic accountability and fairness - Digital divides and inclusion - Technology and democracy / civic participation - Emerging technologies (AI, biotech, quantum) and society - Technology adoption and acceptance - Privacy and surveillance - Technology and labor / future of work - Technology and sustainability transitions

Source: <https://www.sciencedirect.com/journal/technology-in-society>

Article Types

- **Research Article** (unsolicited, full-length)
- **Review Article**
- **Short Communication**
- **Special Issue articles** (by invitation)

No explicit word limit published, but standard Elsevier research articles typically run 6,000–8,000 words.

Formatting Requirements

Element	Requirement
File format	.docx (single-column) or .tex (double-column allowed for LaTeX)
PDF-only submissions	Rejected — must provide editable source
Strikethrough/underlined text	Remove unless scientifically significant
Line numbers	Required for review

Element	Requirement
Page numbers	Optional
Running head	Optional
Font	12pt, serif (Times New Roman or similar)
Margins	2.5 cm (1 inch) standard

Manuscript Structure

1. **Title page** — title, author names, affiliations, corresponding author email, ORCID
2. **Structured abstract** — Background, Methods, Results, Conclusions (Elsevier convention)
3. **Keywords** — 6–10 keywords
4. **Main text** — Introduction, Methods, Results, Discussion, Conclusion
5. **Declarations** (see below)
6. **References** — Elsevier numbered format [1], [2,3]
7. **Figures** — embedded or separate, .pdf/.tiff/.jpg, 300+ dpi
8. **Tables** — editable, not images

Reference Style

- **Numbered citations** in square brackets: [1], [2,3], [4–7]
- Numbered sequentially in order of first appearance
- Reference list at end, numbered
- Format: Author names, article title, journal name, volume (issue) (year) pages. DOI URL

Source: Elsevier numbered reference style (standard across most Elsevier journals)

Figure and Table Requirements

Element	Requirement
Figure resolution	300+ dpi
Figure formats	.pdf (preferred), .tiff, .jpg
Figure numbering	Sequential (Fig. 1, Fig. 2...)
Figure captions	Below figure, descriptive
Table format	Editable text (not images)
Table numbering	Sequential (Table 1, Table 2...)
Color	Allowed; no extra charge for online

Required Declarations

All of the following are **mandatory** at submission:

1. **Declaration of Generative AI use** — per Elsevier policy, must disclose any AI tool use in writing process
 2. **Ethics Statement** — required even if no human subjects (state that no human subjects were involved)
 3. **Data Availability Statement** — where data/code can be accessed
 4. **CRedit Author Statement** — contributor roles for all authors
 5. **Declaration of Competing Interests** — financial or personal
 6. **Acknowledgments** — funding, assistance (optional but expected)
 7. **Funding** — if applicable
-

AI Disclosure Requirements (Elsevier Policy)

Per Elsevier policy (effective 2023, updated 2025):

- AI tools may be used for language editing, formatting, reference management
- AI tools **must not** substitute for human critical thinking, analysis, or interpretation
- AI tools **cannot** be listed as authors
- Disclosure statement **must** appear in the manuscript (typically before references)
- Statement should name the tool, describe how it was used, and confirm author reviewed all AI-assisted content
- Authors bear full responsibility for all content

Source: <https://www.elsevier.com/about/policies-and-standards/the-use-of-generative-ai-and-ai-assisted-technologies-in-writing-for-elsevier>

Cover Letter Expectations

- Must establish the **technology-society contribution**
 - Must name the **applied or policy implication**
 - Must demonstrate awareness of the journal's interdisciplinary scope
 - Should name specific policy actors who can use the findings
 - Suggested reviewers with affiliations (avoid same-institution and recent co-author conflicts)
-

Submission Portal

- **Platform:** Elsevier Editorial Manager
 - **URL:** <https://www.editorialmanager.com/tis/>
 - **Access:** Via the journal's Guide for Authors page on ScienceDirect
-

Editorial Timeline

Stage	Typical Duration
Intake and technical check	0–5 days
Editor desk-screen	5–21 days
External peer review	4–8 weeks
Decision and revision	8–16 weeks
Submission to first decision	~9 days
Submission to decision after review	~79 days
Submission to acceptance	~195 days
Acceptance to online publication	~2 days

Source: ScienceDirect journal metrics, manusights.com

APC / Open Access

- **Subscription model:** No APC (free to publish)
 - **Gold Open Access option:** \$4,030 USD APC
 - **Green OA:** Allowed per Elsevier sharing policy (accepted manuscript after embargo)
-

Desk Rejection Criteria

Editors screen for three operational signals:

1. **Tech-society substance** — Is there a substantive technology-society contribution, or is this a generic social-science or CS paper?
2. **Methodological rigor** — Are methods appropriate for the claims?
3. **Applied or policy implications** — Does the paper name specific policy actors and actions?

Common desk-rejection patterns: - Pure CS papers without technology-society framing - Pure social-science papers without technology mechanism - Technology impact descriptions without policy actor identification - Missing required declarations - PDF-only submissions

Repository / Code Sharing

- Elsevier encourages data and code sharing
- GitHub repositories should be cited in Data Availability Statement
- Repositories can be private during review, public upon acceptance
- Zenodo DOI recommended for archival preservation
- No specific repository structure requirements from Elsevier

Compiled from official Elsevier sources, ScienceDirect journal page, and manusights.com submission guide. Last verified June 4, 2026.